



FOSS Bytes

Linux is 'bloated and huge', says Linus

As the Linux kernel is becoming increasingly large and more complex, Linux founder Linus Torvalds says his job is getting easier. Speaking on a panel at the LinuxCon conference, Torvalds told the audience that the kernel development model is working better now than ever.



But Torvalds added that there are still areas for improvement and provided a very pointed comment about the current size of the Linux kernel. He added that whenever the kernel adds a new feature, the problem gets worse. That said, he didn't think that features are being added too fast and said that developers are finding bugs quickly.

Meanwhile, Linux 2.6.31 was also released in September (included in LFY CD), and you can read all about it at http://kernelnewbies.org/Linux_2_6_31.

Nero Linux 4: Reviving CD/DVD burning on Linux

Touted as one of the most prominent burning suites for Windows, Nero didn't stand back as far as Linux was concerned. Nero has recently updated its Linux offering and introduced a new version tagged as Nero 4.

The newer version improves overall integration and offers more pronounced support for optical drives and media handling in Linux. Version 4 introduces the Express Wizard, with which Nero simplifies the burning procedure in Linux, giving tough competition to its FOSS counterparts. The drawbacks with other players are incomplete burning integration and improper UDF implementation. Check out a video of Nero Linux 4 at <http://ow.ly/qg52>



ZOH0 launches Discussions

Web-based productivity suite, Zoho, recently launched a brand new product called Zoho Discussions. Zoho lets any business, individual or organisation create public or private support forums where employees or customers can share comments around a particular discussion topic.

With the new product you can create a platform for discussion forums, similar to Google Groups. The differentiating factor is that your forums can be customised and branded to adopt the look and feel of your site. Zoho even lets you pick out a domain name that coincides with your site. Plus, Zoho Discussions can be integrated with many of Zoho's other productivity applications.

Similar to any forum, Zoho Discussion lets users create threads based on a particular topic. In terms of features, Zoho has focused on creating plenty of social tools to make the discussions more interactive and engaging. Aside from posting in the forums, users can interact in real-time through the built-in chat feature. Within the forum, users can create a profile, follow other users, bookmark particular threads and send private messages to administrators and users.

Zoho Discussion has a freemium model, with additional features like more storage, number of forums, number of moderators, etc, priced at \$25 and \$75 per month.

WebGL support awaits Firefox 3.7

It looks like support for the upcoming Web 3D graphics project WebGL is building up fast, as, just one week after it made its way into Webkit's latest experimental source-code releases, Mozilla Firefox 3.7 nightly-builds also sport the new feature. The project is still pretty much in the early stages and has a long way to go until standardisation, but the developers believe there should be a much sturdier implementation within several months.

The idea behind the project is to bring cross-platform, native 3D capabilities to browsers, independent of proprietary plug-ins, Adobe Flash and the likes, using standard Web technologies like JavaScript. It will use the <canvas> element from the upcoming HTML 5 standard and it has the support from most browser makers excluding Microsoft, of course.

One major step forward was when it finally became available, though not enabled by default, in the latest developer releases of Webkit, the open source HTML rendering engine initially developed by Apple and used by Safari, Google Chrome and several Linux and mobile browsers. And now it has also made its way into the Firefox branch codenamed Minefield, which will eventually develop into Firefox 3.7. Just like Webkit, it isn't enabled by default, as there still are several major issues to be handled, but curious users and developers can experiment with the new feature by going to the advanced-settings configuration page 'about:config' and enabling 'webgl.enabled_for_all_sites'.